Checklist of Oregon Gentianaceae

Thea Jaster, Stephen C. Meyers, and Scott Sundberg, eds.
Version 2.4 © 2026 Oregon Flora Project

Centaurium

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 6/13/2003
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Centaurium erythraea Rafn

Common names: common centaury, European centaury
Origin: exotic, naturalized Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2024
FPN2 414; IL 3:352 synonym for *Centaurium umbellatum*; JPM 667; JPM2 812.

Misapplied names:

***Centaurium umbellatum* Gilib.**
FPN 357; IL 3:352; PEK 604; VP 4:59.

Centaurium tenuiflorum (Hoffmanns. & Link) Fritsch

Common names: slender centaury
Origin: exotic, naturalized Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2004
JPM2 812; Pringle, 2010 .

Cicendia

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 4/20/2004
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Cicendia quadrangularis (Dombey ex Lam.) Griseb.

Common names: timwort, Oregon timwort
Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2018
FPN 361; FPN2 414; JPM 667; JPM2 812.

Synonyms:

***Microcala quadrangularis* (Lam.) Griseb.**
FPN 361; IL 3:351; PEK 605; VP 4:74.

Comastoma

Checklist contributor:
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Comastoma tenellum (Rottb.) Toyok.

Common names: slender gentian, Dane's dwarf gentian
Origin: native Voucher: CIC, most recently collected in 1992
FPN2 415; JPM2 812.

Synonyms:

***Gentiana tenella* Rottb.**
FPN 360; IL 3:359; VP 4:73.

***Gentianella tenella* (Rottb.) Börner**
FPN 360; IL 3:359; IN 4:14; VP 4:73 synonym for *Gentiana tenella*.

Gentianella tenella* (Rottb.) Börner ssp. *tenella
JPM 669.

Erythraea

Checklist contributor:
Flora of Oregon author: treatment pending

Erythraea minima Howell

Common names: small centaury

Origin: exotic, not naturalized Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 1883

Frasera

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 4/27/2004

Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Frasera albicaulis Griseb. var. ***albicaulis***

Common names: whitestem frasera, Douglas' frasera

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2007

FPN 358; FPN2 415; VP 4:62.

Synonyms:

Swertia albicaulis* (Douglas ex Griseb.) Kuntze var. *albicaulis

JPM 670.

Frasera albicaulis Griseb. var. ***cusickii*** (A. Gray) C.L. Hitchc.

Common names: Cusick's elkweed

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2022

FPN 358; FPN2 415; IN 4:22; VP 4:62.

Synonyms:

***Swertia cusickii* (A. Gray) H. St. John**

IL 3:363 synonym for *Swertia nitida (Benth.) Jepson ssp. cusickii (A. Gray) Abrams*; PEK 609.

Frasera albicaulis Griseb. var. ***idahoensis*** (H. St. John) C.L. Hitchc.

Common names: Idaho frasera

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2022

FPN 358; FPN2 415; VP 4:62.

Frasera albicaulis Griseb. var. ***modocensis*** (H. St. John) N.H. Holmgren

Common names: Modoc frasera

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2018

IN 4:22; JPM2 813.

Synonyms:

***Swertia modocensis* H. St. John**

IL 3:363 uncertain status; PEK 609.

Frasera albicaulis Griseb. var. ***nitida*** (Benth.) C.L. Hitchc.

Common names: whitestem elkweed

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2023

FPN 358; FPN2 415; IN 4:22; JPM2 813; VP 4:62.

Synonyms:

***Frasera albicaulis* Griseb. var. *columbiana* (H. St. John) C.L. Hitchc.**

FPN 358; FPN2 415; VP 4:62.

***Swertia albicaulis* (Douglas ex Griseb.) Kuntze var. *nitida* (Benth.) Jeps.**

IL 3:363 synonym for *Swertia nitida (Benth.) Jepson ssp. nitida*; JPM 670; PEK 608.

***Swertia columbiana* H. St. John**

FPN 358 synonym for *Frasera albicaulis* var. *columbiana*; IL 3:363 synonym for *Swertia nitida (Benth.) Jepson ssp. nitida*; PEK 609.

***Swertia nitida* (Benth.) Jeps.**

IL 3:363; PEK 608.

Frasera speciosa Douglas ex Griseb.

FPN 357; GWM 272 synonym for *Swertia radiata*; IL 3:362; IN 4:18; JPM2 814; VP 4:63.

Frasera speciosa Douglas ex Griseb. var. ***speciosa***

Common names: giant frasera, monument plant, elkweed

Origin: native Voucher: WTU, most recently collected in 2024

FPN2 415.

Synonyms:

***Swertia radiata* (Kellogg) Kuntze**

FPN 357 synonym for *Frasera speciosa*; GWM 272; IL 3:362; JPM 670; PEK 608.

Frasera umpquaensis M. Peck & Applegate

Common names: Umpqua frasera, Umpqua green-gentian

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 1991

FPN2 415; JPM2 814.

Synonyms:

***Swertia umpquaensis* (M. Peck & Applegate) H. St. John**

IL 3:362; PEK 608.

Gentiana

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 4/13/2004

Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Gentiana affinis Griseb.

FPN 359; FPN2 417; GWM 270; PEK 606.

Gentiana affinis Griseb. var. ***affinis***

Common names: pleated gentian, prairie gentian

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2002

Synonyms:

***Gentiana affinis* Griseb. var. *parvidentata* Kusn.**

IL 3:356.

***Gentiana interrupta* Greene**

PEK 606.

Gentiana affinis Griseb. var. ***ovata*** A. Gray

Common names: Oregon gentian

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2016

IL 3:356 synonym for *Gentiana oregana*; JPM 668; JPM2 814.

Synonyms:

***Gentiana affinis* Griseb. var. *oregana* Engelm. ex A. Gray**

IN 4:10.

***Gentiana oregana* Engelm.**

FPN 359 synonym for *Gentiana affinis*; GWM 271; IL 3:356; PEK 606.

Gentiana calycosa Griseb.

Common names: explorer's gentian, mountain bog gentian

Origin: native Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2018

FPN 359; FPN2 417; GWM 270; IL 3:358; IN 4:10; JPM 668; JPM2 814; PEK 607; VP 4:68.

Synonyms:

Gentiana calycosa* Griseb. var. *calycosa

FPN 359; VP 4:69.

Gentiana newberryi A. Gray

FPN 359; IL 3:356; IN 4:12; JPM 668; PEK 607.

Gentiana newberryi A. Gray var. ***newberryi***

Common names: Newberry's gentian, alpine gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2017
FPN2 416; JPM 668; JPM2 816.

Gentiana plurisetosa C.T. Mason

Common names: Klamath gentian, bristly gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2003
Galash, 2024 ; JPM 668; JPM2 816.

Gentiana prostrata Haenke

FPN 359; FPN2 416; IN 4:8; JPM 669; JPM2 816; VP 4:72.

Gentiana prostrata Haenke var. ***prostrata***

Common names: moss gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 1976

Gentiana sceptrum Griseb.

Common names: king's gentian, staff gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2016
FPN 359; FPN2 416; IL 3:356; JPM 669; JPM2 816; VP 4:72.

Synonyms:

***Gentiana menziesii* Griseb.**
PEK 606.

***Gentiana sceptrum* Griseb. var. *cascadensis* M. Peck**
PEK 606.

***Gentiana sceptrum* Griseb. var. *humilis* Engelm.**
IL 3:358.

Gentiana sceptrum* Griseb. var. *sceptrum
IL 3:356; PEK 606.

Gentiana setigera A. Gray

Common names: Mendocino gentian, elegant gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2023
IL 3:358; JPM 669; JPM2 816.

Synonyms:

***Gentiana bisetaea* Howell**
IL 3:358; PEK 607.

Gentianella

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 4/13/2004
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Gentianella amarella (L.) Börner

FPN 360; GWM 271 synonym for *Gentiana amarella* var. *acuta*; IN 4:12.

Gentianella amarella (L.) Börner ssp. ***acuta*** (Michx.) J.M. Gillett

Common names: autumn dwarf gentian, felwort, northern gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2015
JPM 669; JPM2 816.

Synonyms:

***Gentiana amarella* L.**
FPN 360; VP 4:66.

***Gentiana amarella* L. var. *acuta* (Michx.) Herder**
GWM 271; IL 3:359; PEK 605.

Gentianopsis

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 4/13/2004
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Gentianopsis simplex (A. Gray) H.H. Iltis

Common names: one-flowered gentian
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2016
FPN2 417; IN 4:16; JPM 669; JPM2 816.

Synonyms:

***Gentiana simplex* A. Gray**
FPN 359; GWM 271 synonym for *Gentianella simplex*; IL 3:360; PEK 606; VP 4:73.

***Gentianella simplex* (A. Gray) J.M. Gillett**
GWM 271.

Swertia

Checklist contributor: Henrietta Chambers, 4/20/2004
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Swertia perennis L.

Common names: star swertia, felwort
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2019
FPN 361; FPN2 418; GWM 272; IN 4:16; JPM 670; JPM2 817; KZ 1:322; PEK 608; St. John, 1941 26:1-29; VP 4:76.

Synonyms:

***Swertia perennis* L. var. *obtusa* (Ledeb.) Ledeb. ex Griseb.**
IL 3:362.

Zeltnera

Checklist contributor: Stephen Meyers, 1/5/2011
Flora of Oregon author: James Pringle

Zeltnera exaltata (Griseb.) Mansion

Common names: western centaury, Great Basin centaury
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2019
FPN2 418; JPM2 817; Mansion, 2004 .

Synonyms:

***Centaurium exaltatum* (Griseb.) W. Wight ex Piper**
FPN 357; IL 3:354; IN 4:6; JPM 667; PEK 604; VP 4:58.

Zeltnera muehlenbergii (Griseb.) Mansion

Common names: Muehlenberg's centaury, Monterey centaury
Origin: native
Voucher: OSC, most recently collected in 2021
FPN2 418; JPM2 817; Mansion, 2004 .

Synonyms:

***Centaurium muehlenbergii* (Griseb.) W. Wight ex Piper**
Grisebach, 1839 ; IN 4:5; JPM 667.

***Centaurium muhlenbergii* (Griseb.) W. Wight ex Piper**
FPN 357; IL 3:352; PEK 604; VP 4:58.

Excluded names:

Centaurium pulchellum (Sw.) Druce

FPN2 414; Hooker, 1745 ; JPM2 812.

Frasera fastigiata (Pursh) A. Heller

FPN 358; FPN2 415; IL 3:362; VP 4:62.

Synonyms:

***Swertia fastigiata* Pursh**

IL 3:362; JPM 670; PEK 608.

Literature cited for Gentianaceae

(Excluding the standard references unless specifically cited in the flora manuscript.)

Chambers, K.L., and J. Greenleaf. 1989. *Gentiana setigera* is the correct name for *G. bisetaea* (Gentianaceae). Madroño 36(1):49-50.

Galash, D. 2024. Personal communication, rare plant abstracts, draft content. .

Gillett, J.M. 1957. A revision of the North American species of *Gentianella* Moerch. Annals of the Missouri Botanical Garden 44:195-269.

Grisebach, A.H.R. 1839. Genera et Species Gentianearum adjectis Observationibus Quibusdam Phytogeographicis. J.G. Cottae, Stuttgart, Germany.

Hooker, W.J. 1745. Flora boreali-americana, or, the botany of the northern parts of British America. Volume 2. Henry G. Bohn, London, England.

Iltis, H.H. 1965. The genus *Gentianopsis* Moerch. Sida 2:129-154.

Mansion, G. 2004. A new classification of the polyphyletic genus *Centaurium* Hill (Chironiinae, Gentianaceae): description of the New World endemic *Zeltnera*, and reinstatement of *Gyrandra* Griseb. and *Schenkia* Griseb. Taxon 53:719-740.

Mason, C.T. 1960. Studies in the perennial Gentians: *G. newberryi* and *G. tiogana*. Madroño 15:233-239.

Pringle, J.S. 2010. The identity and nomenclature of the Pacific North American species *Zeltnera muhlenbergii* (Gentianaceae) and its distinction from *Centaurium tenuiflorum* and other species with which it has been confused. Madroño 57(3):184-202.

St. John, H. 1941. Revision of the genus *Swertia* (Gentianaceae) of the Americas and the reduction of *Frasera*. American Midland Naturalist 26:1-29.

Abbreviations Used

FN = Flora of North America
FPN = Flora of the Pacific Northwest
FPN2 = Flora of the Pacific Northwest, 2nd editio
FOO = Flora of Oregon
GWM = Guide to the plants of the Wallowa Mountains of northeastern
IL = An Illustrated Flora of the Pacific States
IN = Intermountain Flora
IPNI = The International Plant Names Index
JPM = The Jepson manual, first edition
JPM2 = The Jepson manual, second edition
KZ = A synonymized checklist...(Kartesz)
PEK = A manual of the higher plants of Oregon
VP = Vascular Plants of the Pacific Northwest